

the company to transfer funds to a supposed supplier in Hungary.

14 CONTINUOUS INTELLIGENCE

In data science, the biggest trend going forward is to combine all the data from sensors and databases to provide continuous intelligence. Vaibhav Vasa, Director of Biz Analyst explains, “real-time reporting has been a great asset in 2020 as it gives entrepreneurs the ability to base their decisions on data that are relevant to the decisions they will be making, on inventory, the load on the delivery system, the revenue pipeline, and so much more. At Biz Analyst, we’ve personally developed features like Automatic Outstanding Reminders, Added Delivery & Receipt Note entries in our Data Entry feature, Follow Up Reminder feature, and more post lockdown to facilitate remote working during the period. The response has been overwhelming and we’ve grown by 50 per cent in 10 months. Our app has seen a massive adoption not just by corporates but even manufacturers, traders, distributors, and wholesalers, and this is a testament to the readiness of enterprises here to move towards digital infrastructures.”

One of the places where the technology can be used to provide confidence to meat consumers, by ensuring the quality and safety of the product. Shan Kadavil, CEO, FreshToHome said, “today’s customers are smart. They seek validation for the products they consume. Therefore, a certification of a product’s safety and quality are of utmost importance. There has also been a change in the purchase pattern as the customers of today are looking a quality product that is transparent in its ingredients, neat in packaging, and allows traceability of source. FreshToHome platform offers the freshest meat and fish thanks to the AI-powered supply chain technology, aided by a cold chain used by its sellers. This is to ensure that our customers get 100 per cent chemical-free and preservative-free products.”

15 ANDROID IOT DEVICES

Android is proving to be a terribly convenient, versatile and powerful OS beyond smartphones. The increase in digitisation means that there will be a number of devices that are synced to the cloud, and managed centrally. The pressure on developing contactless technologies for self service at say bus terminals or banks has also made Android the platform of choice for a wide range of devices that use a touch interface. A number of sensors and tests are being developed, as well as telemedicine services, that are all easier to test, deploy and roll out on Android devices. Going forward, there will only be an increase in demand for wearables, sensors, kiosks and other bits and pieces of technology, that will be based on Android.

This increased the load on companies such as Esper, that provide cloud based device management solutions at scale. “2020 has proven to be a challenging year,” says Shiv Sundar, Co-Founder and COO at Esper. “However, it was also a year of new opportunities and avenues for us. One particular trend that we witnessed was the acceleration of digital transformation with traditional companies. Incorporating customer interactivity into their solution became a priority and the execution ranged from standing up self-service kiosks to augmenting the customer experience with innovative digital solutions. Android based devices, in particular, have been deployed at a large scale to meet these demands. This has underscored how important a product like Esper is to fill the large gap to enable enterprises - small and large alike, to deploy devices at scale and have rigorous control over how their applications are deployed and monitored on their devices.”

The accelerated transformation is only expected to continue in 2021, “Looking ahead, we realise that the pandemic has ushered in a new era that will be more digital and virtual, even in remote locations. Industries

like education, fitness, restaurants and healthcare will see a flurry of Android based devices and Android will become a dominant choice of OS for Touch based IoT devices. At Esper, we are moving ahead with a sustained hyper focus on our customer service. We have an amazing slate of features in the pipeline that will help our customers deploy and scale their device fleet. We are looking forward to a great new year for our customers, partners and our amazing set of employees.”

Strangely enough, Google’s focused foray into embedded IoT operating systems, Android Things is deprecated and the Dashboard is going to shut down in January 2021.

16 CYBERATTACKS ON PHARMA

The outbreak was followed by a series of ransomware attacks on hospitals and other health care facilities. In the US, a ransomware known as Ryuk was used to infect hospital networks. Similarly, hospitals across Europe were targeted with ransomware attacks too. An elite threat actor known as DarkHotel even tried to attack the World Health Organisation. In November 2020, Microsoft released details of how its security solutions had intercepted emails from spear phishing campaigns, by suspected state sponsored actors who tried to infiltrate the systems of the organisations working with and developing vaccines for the novel coronavirus. pharmaceutical companies and vaccine manufacturers in France, India, Canada, South Korea and the United States were all targets of the attack. An actor known as Strontium, associated with Russia and two others called Zinc and Cerium, associated with North Korea were responsible for the attacks. Going forward, security researchers expect attacks on hospitals, pharmaceutical companies and healthcare organisations to only increase in the coming months. Jakub Kroustek, Threat Labs Team Lead at Avast says, “We expect to see a continuation of ransomware attacks on healthcare institutions and the exfil-